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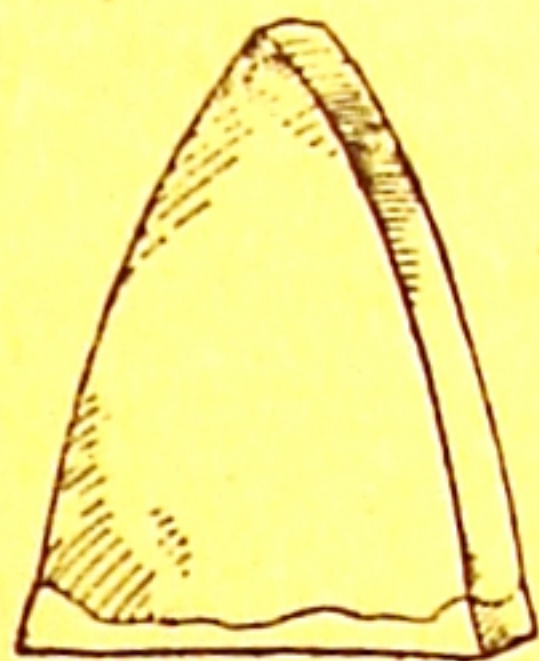
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1896.

A STELE OF THE XIIITH DYNASTY.

BY W. E. CRUM.

The British Museum has recently acquired a limestone monument (No. 1163) from "Thebes," of considerable interest. In the first place, its form is very unusual; it is a stele in the shape of a thin cone with four flat faces. Its height is 2 ft. 4 in.; the width of each of the broad faces is 1 ft. 3 in. at the base, but tapering to a point at the top; the width of each narrow face is 9 in. Above the inscriptions there is, upon every face, a blank space of 4 or 5 in.; below, a like space of some 8 in. The inscriptions on the two narrow faces (C and D, *below*) were coloured; the hieroglyphics blue, the male figure red with a blue collar, the female yellow. On the sides A and B neither texts nor pictures were coloured.



Secondly, the king's name which the stele bears—that of Sbkmsaf II—is a very rare one, hitherto known to us only from the Abbott and Amherst papyri, which tell of the king's tomb at Thebes.*

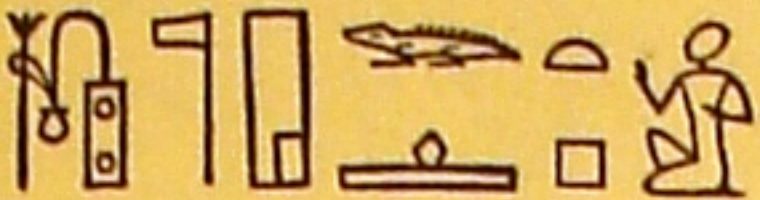
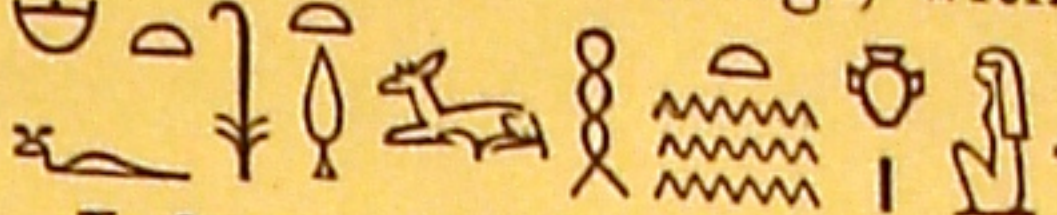
Thirdly, the texts contain a hymn to the sun-god, very short indeed, but employing formulæ not to be found, so far as I can recollect, upon any of the monuments of the Middle Kingdom.

Finally, the unusual manner of depicting certain of the offerings may be noticed. On A, above the table on which lie the smaller gifts, an inverted lotus blossom with long, wide open petals, is suspended, while on each side of its stalk hangs a goose, head downwards, somewhat in the style of those decorated columns which were fashionable at Tell el-Amarna.

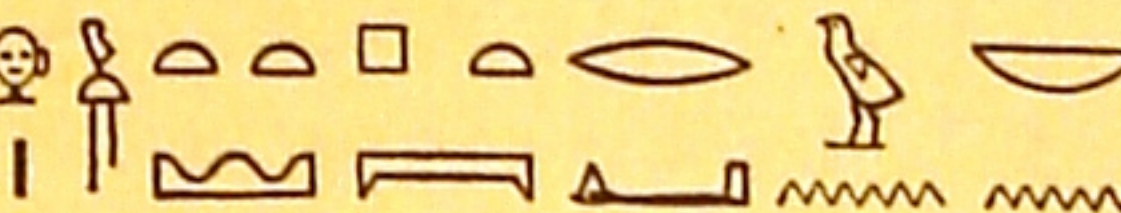
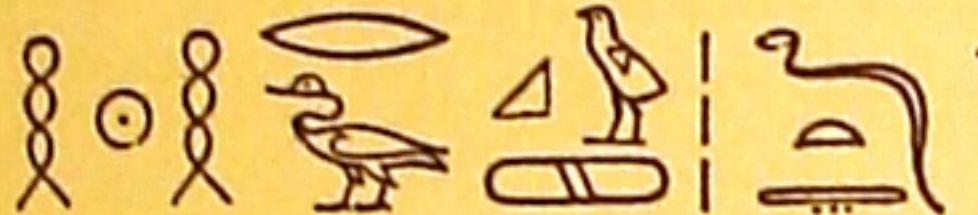
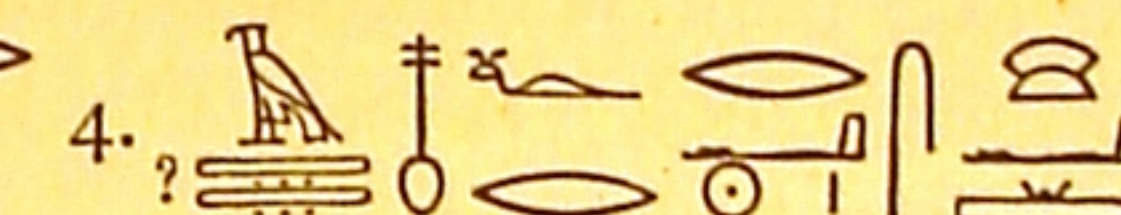
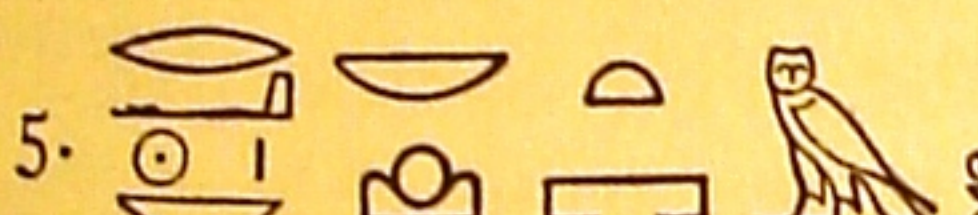
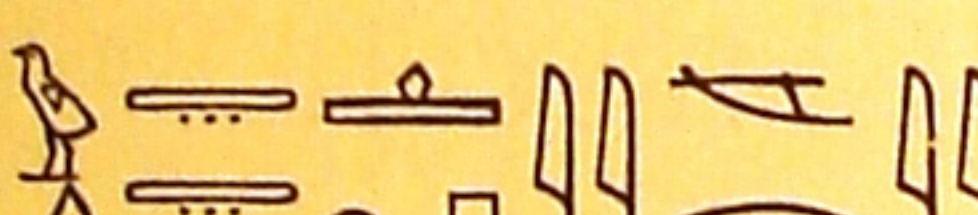
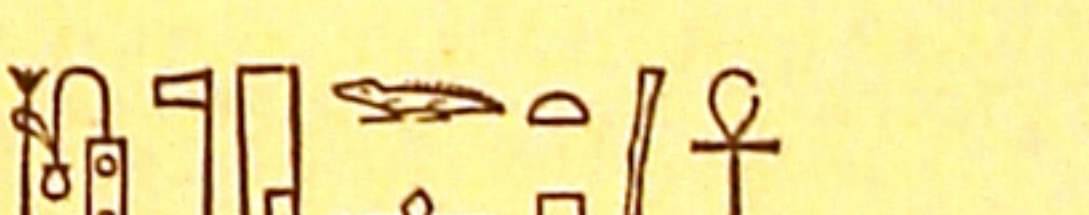
The following are the texts, of which the signs are roughly cut, and here and there ambiguous. Sometimes they are obviously in need of correction.

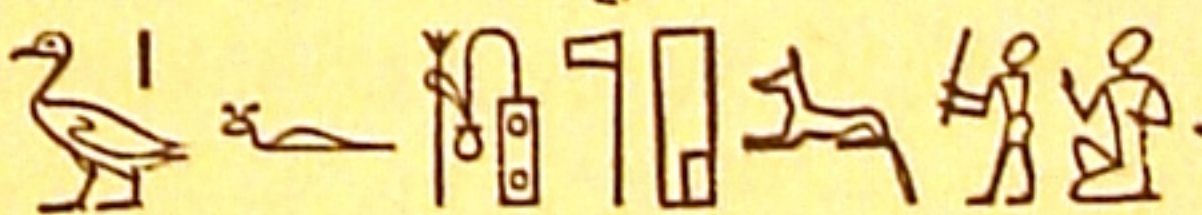


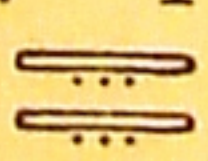
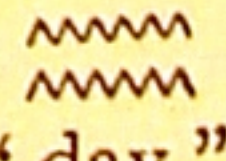
* v. Petrie, *History*, I, 223.

Below, a man and woman stand before the table of offerings, with the inscriptions  and .

The first words should read  (*Mon. div.*, 27*b*), and show that the monument was a complimentary gift from the king. They are not found thus before the end of the Middle Kingdom. Are we to assume from line 2 that a temple of Sobek existed at Thebes in the time of the XIIIth dynasty? The words '*Inpw htp sw*' appear to be a parenthetic ejaculation, "May Anubis rest him!" (*or* Imperative). After the owner's name, *Sbkhtp*, begins the hymn to the rising sun, which, though it contains no uncommon words, I will not venture to translate.

B. 1. *  2.  3. 
 4.  5.  6. 
 7. 

Below, a man and boy before the table of offerings. The man's designation is in line 7. The boy is .

The text continues the hymn, now to the setting sun; "Praise to thee, Re' Harmachis on the west of heaven! To thee is given (? *rditw* *) eternity for food, the ages for drink. The two lands are fair the day that thou shinest as Re', lord of the horizon,† as Thoth, lord of Hermopolis. Thou king of heaven, guide of the two lands that are at peace and beloved (of thee), give peace‡ to the temple—scribe *Sbkhtp*." I cannot identify the word (l.l. 3, 4) for "drink," and the signs  which come after it might be as well read  I do not know whether *r'* can at this period be used for "day." The grammatical forms in the phrases following are difficult to determine. A translation too which would make Thoth a sun-god is very questionable.

* But *v.* Max Müller, *A.Z.*, XXIX, 89, note.

† The second *nb* superfluous?. ‡ This translation requires rather *shtpw*.

